

# STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT

## Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

### Project Document

|                        |                                                                   |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Project Area</b>    | IT Service Management / Procurement Automation                    |
| <b>Platform</b>        | ServiceNow – Flow Designer                                        |
| <b>Process</b>         | Standard Laptop Request and Fulfilment                            |
| <b>Key Requirement</b> | Form teams physically without waiting for SkillWallet credentials |

### 1. Introduction

The project focuses on streamlining the IT procurement process for standard laptop orders by using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The objective is to replace repetitive manual activities with an automated workflow that captures a request, validates the required information, routes the request for approval, creates fulfilment tasks, and keeps stakeholders informed of progress.

### 2. Problem Statement

Standard laptop requests can involve multiple manual steps, including request submission, approval, procurement coordination, inventory checks, assignment of fulfilment tasks, and communication with the requester. Manual coordination can increase processing time and create the possibility of missed tasks or inconsistent updates.

For project execution, teams should also be formed physically at the beginning of the activity instead of waiting for SkillWallet credentials. This allows team members to coordinate, divide responsibilities, and start the project documentation and workflow work immediately. SkillWallet credentials can be handled separately when required.

### 3. Project Objectives

- Automate the standard laptop procurement workflow using Flow Designer.
- Reduce manual coordination between requesters, approvers, procurement, and fulfilment teams.
- Ensure every approved request generates the required fulfilment activities.
- Provide clear status updates to the requester.
- Improve consistency and traceability of laptop orders.
- Enable project teams to be formed physically without waiting for SkillWallet credentials.

## 4. Proposed Solution

A ServiceNow Flow Designer workflow will be created for standard laptop requests. When a requester submits the required information, the flow evaluates the request, obtains the necessary approval, and automatically creates the next fulfilment activities. Notifications can be generated at important stages so that the requester and responsible teams can track progress.

## 5. High-Level Workflow

| Step | Activity                                  | Expected Result                                         |
|------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Requester submits standard laptop request | Request is recorded with required details               |
| 2    | Flow is triggered                         | Automation starts automatically                         |
| 3    | Validate request details                  | Incomplete/invalid requests are identified              |
| 4    | Approval                                  | Request is routed to the appropriate approver           |
| 5    | Procurement / inventory check             | Laptop availability or procurement action is determined |
| 6    | Create fulfilment task                    | Responsible team receives a task                        |
| 7    | Notify requester                          | Requester receives progress/status information          |
| 8    | Complete request                          | Laptop order is fulfilled and request is closed         |

## 6. Flow Designer Components

The implementation can use the following Flow Designer elements:

- Trigger – starts the flow when a standard laptop request is submitted or created.
- Actions – validate data, update records, create tasks, send notifications, and update request status.
- Approvals – send the request to the appropriate approval group or approver.
- Conditions – determine whether the request is complete, approved, available from inventory, or requires procurement.
- Flow Logic – control the sequence of activities and handle different outcomes.
- Notifications – inform requesters and fulfilment teams about important status changes.

## 7. Team Formation and Project Readiness

The project team can be formed physically at the start of the project so that members can immediately discuss the process, assign responsibilities, prepare the workflow, and work on the project document. The team should not remain idle while waiting for SkillWallet credentials. Credentials may be completed separately according to the platform or training requirement.

### Suggested team responsibilities:

- Team Coordinator – coordinates meetings, task allocation, and project progress.
- Process Analyst – documents the existing and proposed procurement process.
- Flow Designer – builds and tests the ServiceNow automation.
- Testing Member – prepares test cases and validates the workflow.

- Documentation Member – maintains screenshots, results, observations, and final project documentation.

## 8. Expected Benefits

- Faster processing of standard laptop requests.
- Less dependency on manual follow-up.
- Consistent approval and fulfilment steps.
- Better visibility of request status.
- Improved task ownership and traceability.
- Reduced chances of missed procurement activities.
- A repeatable workflow that can be extended to other standard IT requests.

## 9. Testing Plan

| Test Case                               | Expected Result                                     |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Submit valid laptop request             | Flow starts successfully                            |
| Submit request with missing information | Validation identifies the issue                     |
| Request is approved                     | Fulfilment/procurement task is created              |
| Request is rejected                     | Requester receives appropriate status/update        |
| Laptop available in inventory           | Fulfilment proceeds according to the defined path   |
| Laptop unavailable                      | Procurement path is initiated                       |
| Task completed                          | Request status is updated and requester is notified |

## 10. Conclusion

The proposed Flow Designer solution provides a structured and automated approach for standard laptop procurement. By connecting request submission, validation, approval, procurement/availability checks, fulfilment tasks, and notifications in one workflow, the process becomes easier to track and manage. Forming the project team physically at the beginning also enables immediate collaboration without making SkillWallet credentials a prerequisite for starting the project work.

End of Project Document